If this Tagorean effort antedated the Swadeshi movement, Muslim merchants and zamindars started the Bengal Steam Navigation Company after the Partition of Bengal and ran a passenger service competing with two foreign concerns. Started with a capital of Rs 10 lakh, it provided weekly services between Chittagong and Rangoon. Headquartered at Rangoon, the company boasted of agencies in Calcutta, Chittagong and Akyab. It was successful enough to announce a dividend of 7.5 per cent.[5] Another venture was the Eastern Bengal Steam Service, a joint-stock company established by Raja Srimath Roy and Brothers of Bhagykul.[6] The Roy Brothers also started the East Bengal Mahajan Flotilla Company.[7]

In the high noon of Swadeshism, south India too was not left behind.

In April 1906, it was reported that a Madras Steam Navigation Company had been registered with a capital of Rs 10 lakh for sailing between south India and Burma.[8] In an effort to purchase a vessel, one of its directors had even proceeded to Glasgow.[9] At about the same time, *Swadesamitran* also made note of an attempt—it is not clear if it fructified—for a firm meant to serve the Jaffna–Point Calimere route.[10]

In late 1908, even as SSNCo was battling BI, one C.S. Ganapati Aiyar mooted the idea of launching the South Indian Steam Navigation Company 'much on the same lines as the Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company'. Intended to serve the route between Rangoon and Madras, its promoters did not fail to draw attention to the prevailing political mood ('in these days of Swadeshism').[11] Plans to start a Canara Steam Navigation Company in Mangalore in late 1910 did not bear fruit.[12]

One Madras Steamship Company sailed between Rangoon and Madras sometime in the 1910s—the dates are not clear. The company owned the *Maclean*, a second-hand steamer. A.V. Joseph, a saw miller and timber merchant based in Rangoon, with interests in this company, said he had to insure the ship worth Rs 3.5 lakh for only half its value due to the deviousness of the British underwriters. When the ship was lost, the insurance company, despite its promise to pay £17,000 shelled out only